Product 3: Luxe Korean Under Eye Balm (stick), the short version

1. In one sentence

A twist-up moisturising stick, like a big lip balm, that you swipe under the eyes to soften dry, crepey (finely crinkled, like crepe paper) skin and give concealer (skin-coloured makeup that hides dark circles) a smooth base.

2. What it is, in detail

- **Format:** a solid balm in a lavender twist-up tube.
- **Price:** $39.95 on luxe.com (buy one, get one free); $34.99 on luxeresearchlab.com.
- **Size:** not stated. Look-alike Amazon listings say 0.38 oz (about 10.8 g).
- **Lasts:** about 1 to 3 months with twice-daily use, by the brand's figures.
- **Base:** the full ingredient list isn't published. Rival sticks are mostly **waxes and oils**, with the "star" ingredients in small amounts. Buyers describe Luxe the same way: like Vaseline or lip balm.
- **Free from:** retinol (vitamin A), fragrance, alcohol, essential oils, parabens and artificial colours.

Ingredient	What it does
Adenosine (the lead ingredient; a small molecule found in every cell)	Anti-wrinkle. In one trial of 126 women aged 45–65, adenosine cream made the skin around the eyes smoother after 3 and 8 weeks. Luxe's amount is unknown.
Niacinamide (vitamin B3)	Strengthens the skin barrier and slowly fades brown pigment. Named on one Luxe shop only.
Hyaluronic acid (a sugar-based molecule)	A "sponge": pulls water into the top layer so fine dry lines look softer for a while.
Bisabolol (from chamomile)	Calms redness and irritation.
Vitamin E	An antioxidant that keeps the oils fresh.
Argan oil (a Moroccan nut oil)	Softens and helps the stick glide.
PDRN (pieces of DNA, usually from salmon)	Fashionable. Promising when injected; too big to soak in from a cream.
Collagen (the skin's "scaffolding" protein)	A moisturising film. Too big to soak in.

3. How this kind of product works

Why the under-eye is different. Eyelid skin is the thinnest on the face: if cheek skin is a winter coat, under-eye skin is a silk scarf. It has fewer oil glands and less collagen and elastin (the protein that lets skin snap back), so it dries and lines first.

"Tired eyes" is up to six problems: brown pigment; blue or purple blood vessels showing through; shadow from a hollow; morning puffiness (fluid); bags (fat pushing forward); and crepey, dry, lined skin. Most people over 50 have more than one.

The types: eye creams, gels, serums, caffeine serums (for puffiness), balm sticks, gel patches, instant tighteners (a film that tightens for a few hours) and retinol eye creams.

The science, in kitchen words. Moisturisers use three kinds of ingredient:

- **Humectants** (a sponge) pull water in.

- **Emollients** (butter in a cracked cake) fill gaps between dry flakes.
- **Occlusives** (a lid on a saucepan) seal water in.

A balm stick is mostly emollient and occlusive, so it's very good at the "lid" job. Moist skin swells slightly, like a soaked raisin, so fine dry lines flatten. Real, but temporary.

What no cream can do: it works on the top layer only. It can't move fat, fill a hollow or hide veins.

The trend. Korean sticks took off through K-dramas (Korean TV dramas) around 2022, then TikTok and Amazon in 2025–26. Luxe is a late entry.

4. How it's used, and with what

Steps:

1. Wash hands and face gently. Any thin hydrating serum goes first.
2. Twist up 1–2 mm. Warm the tip on your skin for 2–3 seconds.
3. Glide one light line along the bone below the eye, outer corner inwards. Don't press or rub.
4. Stay a fingertip below the lashes, **never on the waterline** (the wet inner rim of the lid).
5. Tap it in with the ring finger (the weakest finger). About a grain of rice per eye.
6. Wait 1–2 minutes. Morning: mineral (zinc) sunscreen, then a little concealer. Night: balm is the last step.
7. Wipe the tip, cap it, don't share it.

In a routine: thinnest to thickest: cleanse → serum → moisturiser → balm under the eyes → sunscreen → makeup.

Pairs with: a hydrating serum underneath; mineral sunscreen; caffeine serum or a cold compress for puffy mornings; colour corrector.

Take care with: retinol near the eyes (alternate nights, or balm first as a "buffer"); acids near the lids; heavy powder on top. Put contact lenses and eye drops in before the balm.

What you'll see: smoother skin in minutes, fading within hours; less dryness in 1–2 weeks; possibly softer lines in 3–8 weeks. Never: bags, hollows or blue veins gone.

5. Who it's for

Good fit: dry, crepey under-eyes; creasing concealer; eyes that sting with retinol or fragrance; stiff or shaky hands.

After 50 and 60:

- **50s (menopause):** skin collagen and thickness fall about 1–2% a year after menopause, and skin holds less water. Crepiness grows and fat bags often grow.
- **60s:** thinner skin shows veins and muscle, so circles look bluer. The bone around the eye recedes, so hollows deepen. Dry eye and new sensitivities are more common.

Weak or not for: blue circles, hollows, fat bags, morning puffiness (no caffeine), oily skin (too rich). Not on eyelid eczema, infection or after eye surgery. Nut, fish or chamomile allergies: check first (argan, possibly salmon PDRN, bisabolol).

6. The problems it solves

Problem	Why it happens	How this product helps
Dryness	Few oil glands; less water after menopause	**Good.** Its main job: sealing water in.
Crepey skin	Thin skin, sun, menopause, rubbing	**Its strongest use.** Smooths the look for hours; adenosine may add a little over weeks.

Problem	Why it happens	How this product helps
Concealer creasing	Skin bunches when you smile; dry skin "drinks" concealer	**Good**, as a smooth, moist base.
Fine lines, crow's feet	Expression, collagen loss, sun	**Fair.** Instant softening; maybe more in 3–8 weeks.
Stinging lids	Fragrance, retinol, product in the eye	**A plus**: retinol- and fragrance-free.
Brown circles	Genetics, sun, rubbing	**Weak.** Sunscreen matters more.
Blue or purple circles	Veins showing through thin skin	**Poor.** Use a peach corrector.
Hollows, shadows	Bone, shrinking cheek fat, deep tear trough	**None.** Only filler, fat or surgery.
Morning puffiness	Salt, crying, allergies, lying flat	**Weak.** Cold and a raised head in bed help more.
Fat-pad bags	Fat pushing forward through a weak "wall"	**None.** Only surgery removes them.

7. How it compares with competitors

Product	Price	What's different
Medicube PDRN Pink Collagen Volume Multi Balm	$22 / 10 g	Has retinol plus geranium, ylang-ylang, bergamot and rose oils: stronger, but more likely to sting.
Dr.Melaxin Cemenrete Calcium Multi Balm	$19 / 9 g	Sold as "filler in a stick". Also has adenosine and bisabolol.
KAHI Wrinkle Bounce Multi Balm	$24.99 / 9 g	The original "pink stick" that started the trend.
d'Alba All In One Multi Balm	$21 / 10 g	Has added floral citrus fragrance.
CeraVe Eye Repair Cream	$19.99	Drugstore eye cream with niacinamide and caffeine; a dermatologist favourite.
Vaseline or Aquaphor	about $10 a tub	Does the main job (sealing in water) for very little. No actives.

What makes Luxe different: it's the one stick here sold as free of retinol, fragrance and essential oils, which suits thin, older, easily stung lids. It costs more than the Korean rivals, which state their size and full ingredients.

8. What users say

Biggest problems before: concealer creasing in fine lines; crepey, dry skin; dark circles despite sleep; fat bags no cream fixed; stinging, watery eyes; money wasted on pricey eye creams.

How it, or similar sticks, solved them: as a smooth base under concealer and as a moisturiser. Dark circles and crow's feet improved only with eye serums over 2–4 months; bags only with surgery.

Main complaints: "does nothing", "a glorified Vaseline"; greasy or shiny by day, so many use it at night; runs out fast; no change to dark circles or bags for most; too heavy for very thin, pale skin.

Other feedback: value is judged against Vaseline. Many ask how and when to use it. Women over 50 are angry at ads with young or AI models.

Quotes:

1. "I tried this. It did take care of the bags and still worked when I woke from my nap" (Luxe balm)
2. "I recently tried this eye balm it doesn't do anything. It feels like chapstick!" (Luxe balm)

3. "Two weeks into using this I skipped concealer one morning just to test it. My coworker said I looked good." (Luxe, brand's own site, 51)
4. "This eye balm has been a game changer for 59 year old me to be able to put / Concealer on under my eyes without adding creases and wrinkles" (RoC balm stick, 59)
5. "I put it on under my concealer around my eyes and i find my make up goes on smooth and no creases!" (Dr.Melaxin stick)
6. "Doesnt do anything except hydrate like vaseline would be, this is another social media hyped product." (Dr.Melaxin stick)
7. "This eye balm gives a very oily sheen, not suitable to wear during the day time when you are out and about." (KAHI Eye Balm stick)
8. "I am 65, and no matter what I do, the fine and so fine lines show up." (under-eye care, 65)
9. "I'll believe It when I see A WOMAN OF AGE try it" (Dr.Melaxin stick)

Based on: 449 reviews and comments, only 22 on the Luxe balm itself (8 from buyers); 40 from people aged 50+.

9. Words to know

Word	Meaning
Crepey	Thin skin with fine criss-cross wrinkles.
Concealer	Makeup that hides darkness. "Creasing" is when it collects in lines.
Colour corrector	Peach makeup that cancels blue before concealer.
Multi-balm	A stick for eyes, lips, smile lines and neck.
Occlusive	Seals water in, like a lid.
Humectant	Pulls water in, like a sponge.
Adenosine	Luxe's lead anti-wrinkle ingredient.
Retinol	Vitamin A; best-proven for lines, but often stings eyes.
PDRN	Salmon DNA pieces; 2026's fashion ingredient.
Tear trough	The groove from the inner eye corner down the cheek.
Waterline	The wet inner rim of the eyelid. Never put balm there.

10. What you can and can't say on camera

1. Say: "moisturises", "looks smoother", "a smooth base for concealer".
2. Don't say: "lifts", "firms", "removes bags", "fills hollows", "triggers collagen", "fixes collagen loss", "fixes pigment" or "replaces filler or Botox".
3. Keep it on the bone, never the waterline; patch-test first (jaw or behind the ear, 2–3 days).
4. Stop if it stings or swells. Not on an eye infection, eyelid eczema or after eye surgery.
5. See a doctor for swelling under one eye only, or sudden or painful swelling.